Rater Guide

About 10 minutes to read. Keep it open while you rate.

Three rules

1. Work alone. Do not discuss scenes or ratings with other raters until the study ends.
2. No AI tools, internet searches or outside help.
3. Keep the scenes confidential and delete them when the study ends.

What you will do

Part	Task	Amount	Time
Practice	Try a few items, then discuss with the other raters	6 scenes + 1 sequence	about 1 hour
Part A	Score scenes on five dimensions (0-10)	55 scenes	about 4 hours, 3 sittings
Part B	Compare two versions of a five-scene sequence	20 sequences	about 5 hours, 4 sittings

Finish Part A before you start Part B. Always read first and score afterwards.

Part A: Score each scene on five dimensions

Read the whole scene. Then give each dimension a whole number from **0 (none)** to **10 (maximum)**. Judge only the text on the page, even if you know the film.

Dimension	Meaning	0-3	4-7	8-10	Do not count
Pacing	Narrative speed, event progression, momentum	Nothing moves forward	Steady progress, one clear development	Developments follow each other almost without pause	Physical activity on its own (that is Action)
Dialogue	Proportion and importance of spoken dialogue	No speech, or one incidental line	Dialogue and action share the scene	Almost all dialogue, and it carries the scene	Number of speakers; signs or letters not read aloud
Action	Physical action, external events, movement, confrontation, or concrete incident density	Characters stay still	Some purposeful physical activity	Continuous, intense action: fight, chase, disaster	Action that is only talked about; camera directions
Interaction	Density and centrality of character-to-character exchange, conflict, cooperation, or relational movement	One character, or no real engagement	A meaningful exchange for part of the scene	Intense interplay that dominates the scene	Characters merely present; a monologue to no one
Emotion	Affective intensity, tension, distress, intimacy, anger, fear, joy, or dramatic emotional charge	Emotionally flat	Clear emotion or tension	Peak emotion: terror, grief, rage, elation	Which emotion it is; whether you like the film

Score each dimension on its own. A wordless fight is low on Dialogue but high on Interaction; a quiet farewell is low on Action but high on Emotion. Voice-over and phone speech count as dialogue, and a montage counts as one scene.

Part B: Compare two versions of a sequence

Each item shows **Version A** and **Version B** of the same five-scene sequence. **You will not be told which one is the original.** Each item also names one **focus dimension** from Part A. Read both versions completely, then do the three steps.

Step 1 - Focus dimension. For each of the five scenes, score the focus dimension from 0 to 10 for Version A and for Version B, using the Part A table.

Step 2 - What stays the same. For each scene, compare A with B and choose Same, Partly or Different:

	Same	Partly	Different
Characters	Same characters and roles	A minor character added, removed or changed	A main character added, removed or replaced
Setting	Same place and time	Details changed, but the same place and time	A different place or time
Events	Same main events and the same ending	A smaller event changed, but the same ending	A main event or the ending changed

Step 3 - Quality. Score each version of the whole sequence from 1 to 5 on three scales:

Scale	1	3	5
Fluency	Very hard to read, or broken format	Some awkward wording or format problems; still clear	Polished, professional screenplay text
Coherence	Contradictory; scenes do not connect	A noticeable gap or inconsistency	Everything follows; scenes connect naturally
Acceptability	Not usable in a screenplay	Usable only with substantial edits	Usable as it is

Then tick **Unacceptable** for any version that should be rejected outright, and write why in the Note column.

Use the focus dimension only in Step 1. Do not try to guess which version is the original. Length on its own is not a fault.

Filling in the answer sheet

- Each rater receives one Excel workbook. Fill only the **yellow** cells; grey cells are filled in by the organizers.
- Go row by row in the order given; it matches your reading packet.
- Whole numbers only. The sheet will not accept values outside the scale.
- If you are unsure, still give your best score and type **Y** under Unsure.
- Save after each sitting and send the file back without renaming it.